

Radical In-to-me-see

Radical intimacy is the direct result of sharing everything about yourself that is unspeakable, with another person or people, and being willing to experience the next moment, whatever it brings. There is nothing between you and someone else at that moment. You don't need to agree with, or feel good about your partner at any given time

This willingness to transcend your fears and conditioning and stay in relationship is an endless gift. How we relate to someone we love provides an extremely clear and accurate mirror of how we relate to ourselves. For this reason, relationships help us face and understand ourselves more rapidly and profoundly than any other aspect of worldly life.

The Choice of Love



What does the voice of fear
whisper to you?

Fear speaks to you
in logic and reason.

Loving truth says,
"Only give me
this moment."

Fear would walk you
on a narrow path
promising to take you
where you want to go.

Love says,
"Open your arms
and fly with me."

Every moment of your life
You are offered the opportunity

To choose-
Love or fear,
It assumes the language
of love itself.

Fear tells you,
"I want to make you safe."
Love says, "You are safe."

Fear says,
"Give me symbols.
Give me frozen images.
Give me something
I can rely on."

To tread the earth
Or to soar the heavens?

Week One - Context

Introduction

The Art & Science of Mindful Living is not a temporary fix. This is the real thing. It probably won't fit your pictures. But, attempting to fit our pictures is what continues a paralytic treadmill of trying and using techniques and reminders to achieve the life we desire while still operating from our conditioning. Of course, nothing occurs in a vacuum except sweeping up the dirt available and emptying it out each time we sweep.

This program promises the ultimate disruptive support for choosing to see clearly and be in integrity with our natural self.

What are your deepest desires in this program?

What are your fears in this program?

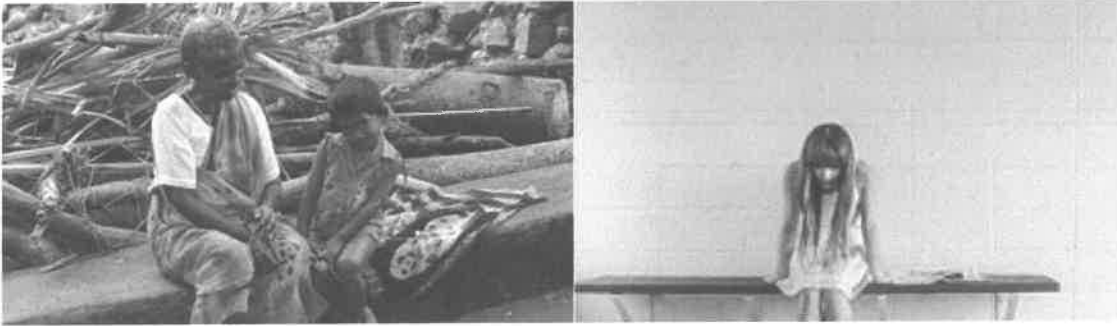
Who are we? What are we?
Do we think people can really hurt our feelings?

Context of Love

Context of Fear

[illegible]

Context vs. Content



Words are only 10% [at best] of a communication. The rest is context.

Children do not hear words; they hear what is behind the words.

So does everybody else.

Role Play:

Imagine a parent saying: "What are you doing?" to a child from a place of:

- Fondness
- Rage
- Suspicion
- Concern

Imagine a person saying: "I feel crazy" to their lover from a place of:

- Blaming it on the other
- Frantic to be understood
- Wanting to share something intimate

Now imagine yourself saying: "Thank you for sharing" from a place of:

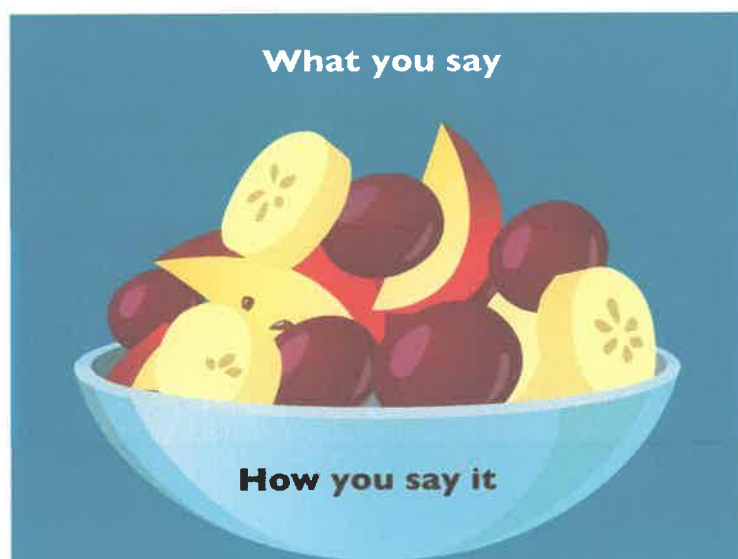
- Terrified to confront anything and wanting to shut someone up
- Judgment of the speaker
- Sarcasm
- Appreciation for what was shared

You get the picture?

Recipe for Setting Context with Mindful Living

(Follow exactly—no substitutions)

1. Have a vision, be your vision.
2. Be real /authentic.
3. Come from the big picture of what needs to happen for the benefit of all.
4. Say exactly what you mean with nothing added or left out.
5. Allow discomfort even though you may feel intimidated or try to make others feel better.
6. Treat everyone as equal beings, including children.
7. Assume that what everyone has to say has value.
8. Ask questions rather than “telling.” Allow discovery
9. Go to the biggest possible picture of what they say.
10. Share your passion about what is important to you.



Do Yourself a F.A.V.O.R.

(*or experiencing value with everyone)

The F.A.V.O.R Method

F - Feel

Know what you are feeling. This is a clue to what the other person is feeling and how you are responding. Put yourself in their place. Recognize in yourself the emotion that is the source of what the other person is saying. Notice any judgments.

A - Acknowledge

Acknowledge the emotion through direct recognition. If not possible, do it in a non-threatening way by exaggeration or humor. Ask a question to clarify the real statement, to confirm that you have received the same emotion that has been sent.

V - Validate

Validate the statement and the other person. This does not mean you have to agree with them. You are letting them know that you've heard them and understand their concern. Remember, if you were that person with their life experiences and their thoughts and feelings, you would respond exactly as they do.

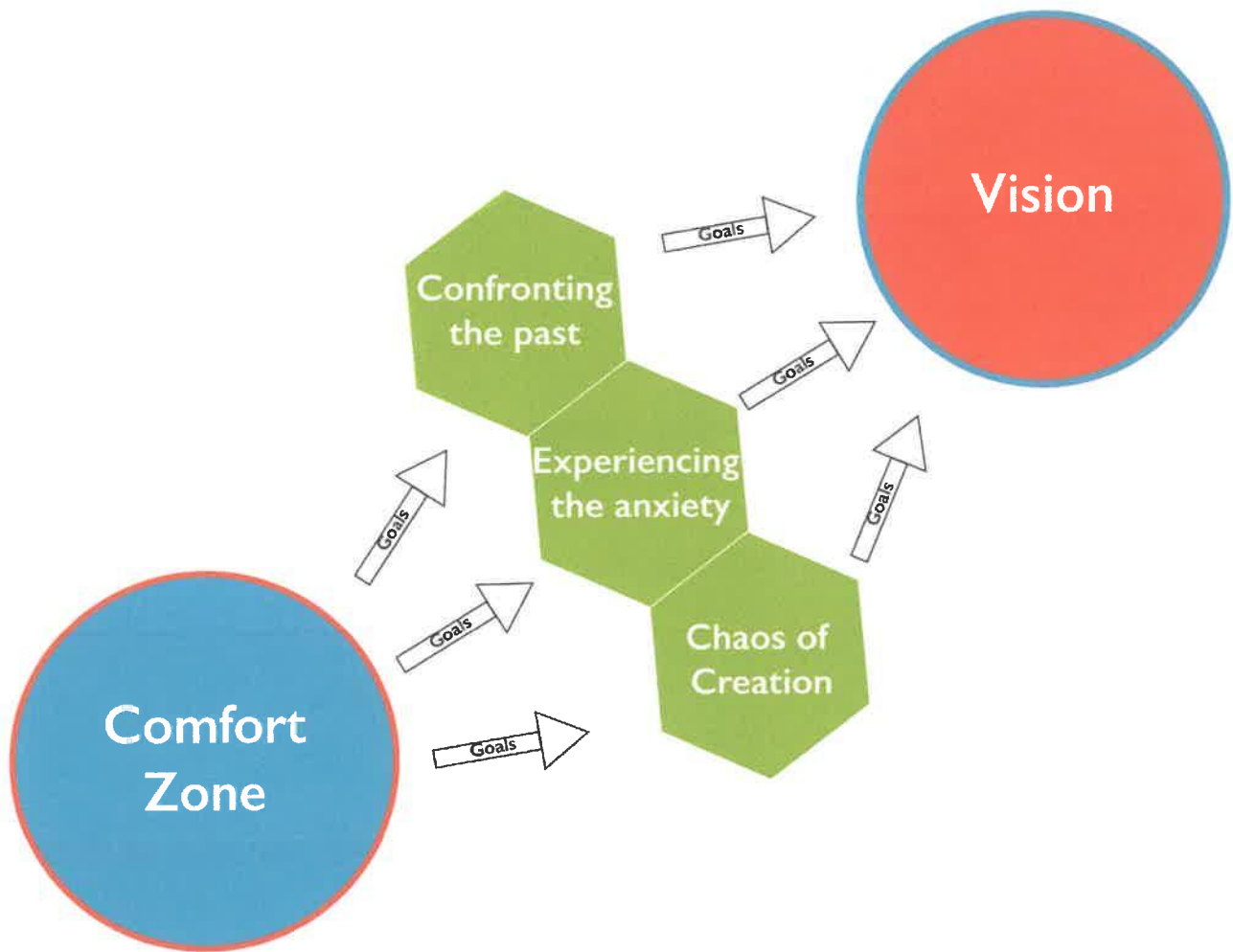
O - Open

Open the space by including yourself in what the other person is describing. "I've felt that way myself." Or share what arises for you. By doing this, you are giving the other person time to realize that he or she is not alone. You are giving yourself the opportunity to connect with yourself and the other person.

R - Return

Return to the original situation. Complete what was started. Relate to your experience, knowledge, or expertise, if applicable. Then let the other person discover the answer to his or her own dilemma.

Leaving the Comfort Zone



Mindful Goal Setting

- Waking up is essential for mindful goal-setting.
- Mindful goal setting requires letting go of your past.
- Sustainable change is impossible without paradox.
- Paradox is a pain in the ass.
- All emotions are equal and essential for achieving goals.
- This entails leaving your comfort zone.

Cognitive Dissonance

Doing everything in the bullet points above is not an easy task. It requires looking deeply at one's self and standing strong in the face of our own limiting beliefs while maintaining a willingness to change. To do this we need to be disrupted, our thoughts and behaviors need to be shaken up. We call this cognitive dissonance. No one likes this experience in the moment.

When cognitive dissonance affects an individual, the brain goes into overload. Old beliefs get shaken. That which was taken as truth is now challenged and called into doubt. In order to learn and take in new information, the brain is agitated in this way. When experiencing cognitive dissonance, we cannot think our way to accept new information, even if it makes sense intellectually. New truths necessitate new behaviors.

COMMITMENT

Until one is committed

there is hesitancy, the chance to draw back,
always ineffectiveness.

Concerning all acts of initiative (and creation)

there is one elementary truth,

the ignorance of which kills countless ideas
and splendid plans:

that the moment one definitely commits oneself,
then Providence moves too.

All sorts of things occur to help one

that would otherwise never have occurred.

A whole stream of events issues from the decision,

raising in one's favor all manner

of unforeseen incidents and meetings

and material assistance

which no man could have dreamt

would have come his way.

I have learned a deep respect

for one of Goethe's couplets:

***“Whatever you can do, or dream you can...begin it. Boldness has genius,
power and magic in it.”***

W.N. Murray, The Scottish Himalayan Expedition, 1951



Wake Up, your life is waiting!!

Self-Assessment of My Progress

My goals for this program are:

The aspects of my past that stand in my way are:

To achieve my goals I will have to feel:

The behaviors essential to achieve my goals are:

What % committed am I at this very moment?

Interim Assignment:

1. Pick a partner.

2. Share your story with your partner. Your partner can interrupt at any point to tell how they are experiencing you and suggest another way to tell it. Notice your response to this each time you are interrupted.

You each do this until you both can make the distinction between feeling fear and being fear. And between feeling love and being love.

3. Practice setting context in relationship, at work, with everyone you meet, all week.

*What do you know
about life?*

Week 2 - Insight

Insight is the result of knowing ourselves. Once we know how we got to where we are, we can use that knowledge to illuminate the future rather than continue to undermine ourselves in the present. Under our beliefs is seeing ourselves in pure awareness, just costumed as points of view.

**Who do we really think we are?
Do we think people don't see us?**

We all have something in us that burns. Insight is the result of sitting in the fire with others to witness the burning.



"Understanding is the booby-prize." –Werner Erhard

Emotions

We know from quantum physics that emotions are simply waves of energy. Sometimes, the wave passes through us as if we are transparent, other times, they stick to us and we react to them and attract the same emotion over and over again. They stick to us until we make certain distinctions about others and ourselves.

Emotions are pure energy and exist both inside and outside of us simultaneously. When an external stimulus occurs that resonates with an emotional state inside of us, we respond based on how well we know ourselves.

What happens to those emotions? Do they stay inside us? All emotions eventually move through us as long as we are willing to experience them fully. When we do not, we wall this un experienced anxiety.

The table below gives some examples of common patterns – from sensations to feelings (interpreted sensation), judgments and reactions. See whether any of the patterns feel familiar to you.

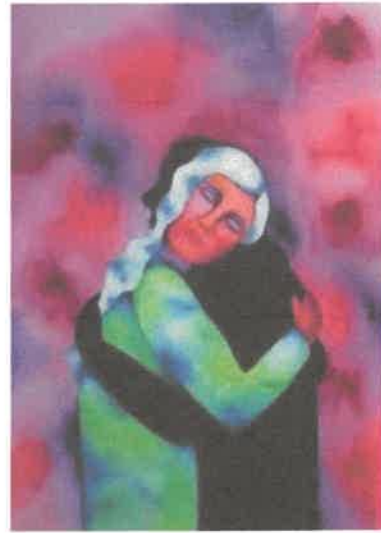
Sensation	Feeling	Judgement	Reaction
Burning	Anger	Not Okay	Blame
Pressure	Fear	Not Okay	Numb/Hysteria
Warmth	Love	Not Okay	Caution/Sexual Pleasure
Emptiness	Needy	Not Okay	Isolation/Bingeing
Full	Happy	Not Okay	Fat/Not Eating
Tingling	Excitement	Okay	No Reaction
Tingling	Turned On	Not Okay	Fighting

There are many events in our past that we want to leave behind, so we cloud them up or create pleasant illusions to cover the pain. When we do this our conscious minds forget what really happened. The effects of these experiences don't disappear. The particles of experience build up and begin to control our behavior, albeit unconsciously. We have extraordinary resistance to opening ourselves to experience the core experience we have been protecting.

The Shadow Knows!



All emotions are equal.
In many ancient healing systems,
emotions are experienced like organs.



Those emotions that we consider
negative are the doorway to freedom,
just like resistance is.

Reflect on your childhood:



1. What feelings were unacceptable in your family?
2. How did you feel you had to behave with your mother?
3. How did you feel you had to behave with your father?
4. Do you feel you have to behave in those ways with anyone in a present relationship?
5. Does anyone in a present relationship have to behave that way with you?
6. What was your father's childhood like?
7. What was your mother's childhood like?

True Desire

You discover you only have a short time to live. What do you want to experience? Who do you want to speak to and what do you want to say?

What is stopping you from living like this now?

How do you want to be remembered?



*Insight is the
preparation for
Personal Responsibility.*

*Who Are You?
What are you made of?*

*Take moments each day
and sit quietly*

Notice life around you

*Sweep the debris
from your mind*



*Reveal paradoxes
in your life.*

*Watch how they
dance in your mind.*



Self-Assessment of My Progress

My Goals for this Program are:

The aspects of my past that stand in my way are:

To achieve my goals I will have to feel:

The behaviors essential to achieve my goals are:

What % committed am I at this very moment?

Interim Assignment:

Use the DeepSee app. Do six days on the first Principle - Insight, and share your journey each day with your partner.

As your partner speaks, share your experience of them.

You will each find out about yourself by watching all the arguments, stories, and explanations that come up in your mind and receiving what your partner's experience of you is.



Personal Journal

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue or grey ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.



Personal Journal

[illegible]

Week 3 - Personal Responsibility

Owning Yourself

Knowing that we are the source and authority of our experience, and recognizing how we create our results – tangible and intangible.

**Who do we really think we are?
Do we think people can make us be
something we are not?**

Exercise:

What outcome or event in your life do you have the biggest resistance to seeing yourself responsible for? Please write down what arises.

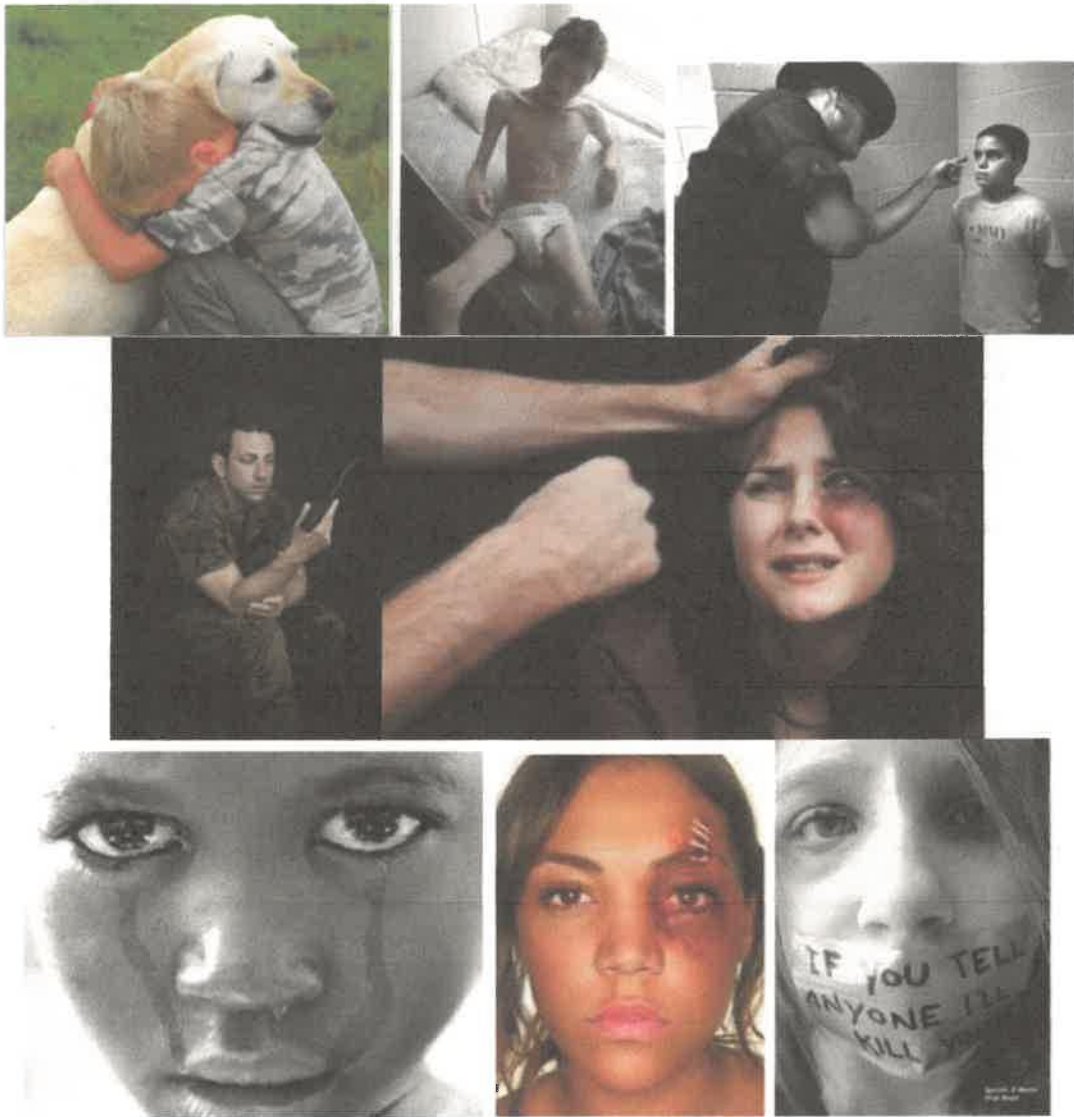


Telling people what they want to hear is a form of dishonesty.

Not saying all that arises to “protect” someone is a form of dishonesty.

Adding a positive or negative spin when sharing is a form of dishonesty.

Take a look at these pictures and reflect on what you feel and think:



Please write down whatever comes up when you look at those pictures, then share with a partner in class:

Take a look at this picture and reflect on what you feel and think:



Please write down whatever comes up when you look at this picture, then share with your partner in class:

What are your beliefs about your body? Stand naked in front of a mirror and notice what you think and feel about your body. Share with your partner in class.

Judge 'Til You Drop



For the next few days, notice your judgments of yourself and others. As you see patterns, we ask you to write them down. After you've noticed your judgments and patterns, then ask yourself

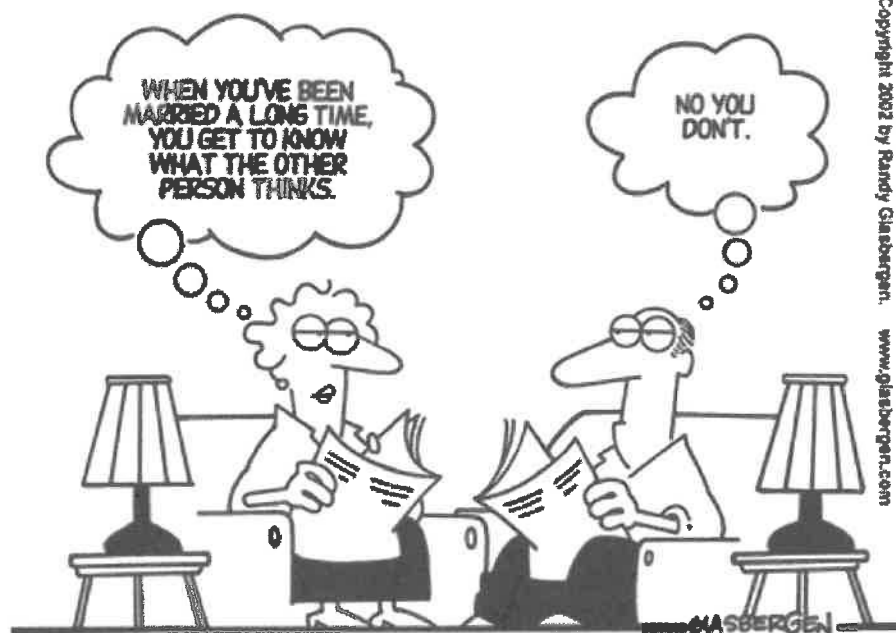
- 1) How do I feel when I judge?
- 2) How do I feel when I am judged?
- 3) How am I like that which I'm judging?
- 4) Imagine life without these judgments.

Judgment always presents itself through a veil of separation. Whether we are judging others or ourselves, and whether we are aware or not, we are engaging in self-abuse.

Check it out!

Projection = Giving Away Our Power

One of the biggest blocks to happiness is a habit everyone learns as a child. It is so ingrained that most of us think it is a natural part of who we are. However, it is not intrinsic to our nature, but learned. It saps us of our power as surely as Kryptonite turned Superman into a weakling. It happens when people do not approve of their feelings and fool themselves into believing the feelings are coming from someone else. This phenomenon is known as “projection.” The problem with projecting is that we see ourselves as victims of someone else’s actions rather than being the author of our own experience. Seeing ourselves as being responsible for our own experience is being truly free.



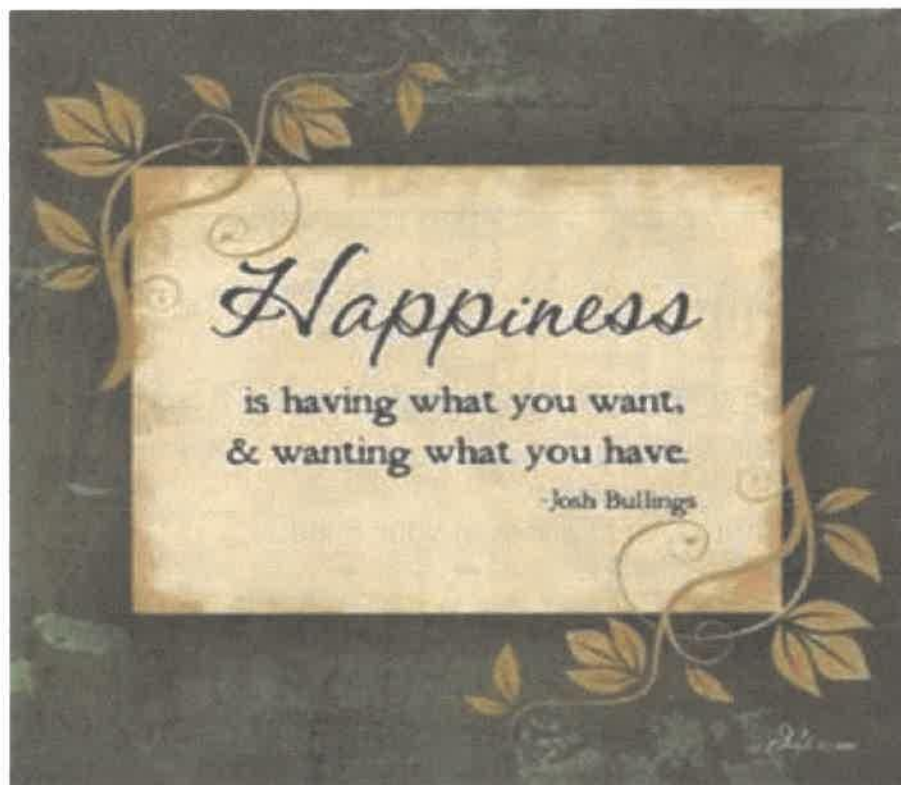
A simple meditation:

Sit quietly for 5 minutes each day. During that time, as your thoughts move, watch them come and go.

Bring to mind those people to whom you have begrudged your love or judged.

How have they have contributed to your life.

Notice how you can hold this paradox.



Self-Assessment of My Progress

My Goals for this Program are:

The aspects of my past that stand in my way are:

To achieve my goals I will have to feel:

The behaviors essential to achieve my goals are:

Interim Assignment:

Use the DeepSee app. Do six days on the second Principle- Responsibility and share your journey each day with your partner.

As your partner speaks, notice what arises in your mind.

Share the content of your mind with your partner.

Continue to examine the question, who am I? By now, you probably have an inkling of the truth of who you are.



Personal Journal

This image shows a full page of blank, lined paper. It features approximately 20 evenly spaced horizontal grey lines running across the width of the page. The lines are thin and consistent in color and thickness. There is no handwriting or other markings on the paper.

Week 4 - Personal Responsibility Towards Others

Making amends for blame and judgment by dissolving 'right vs wrong', 'better vs worse' thinking in favor of a more balanced view and assuming that others have a positive intent. Healing damaged relationships.

Who do we really think we are?

Are we separate from other people?

Reflect on these questions:

Who have you cheated?

Who have you abandoned?

Who have you gossiped about?

Who have you blamed?

Who have you neglected?

Who have you abused?

How have you cheated yourself?

How have you abandoned yourself?

How have you belittled yourself?

What do you blame yourself for?

How do you neglect yourself?

How have you abused yourself?

Who have you lied to?	What lies do you tell yourself?
Who have you led astray?	How have you led yourself astray?
Who have you betrayed?	How have you betrayed yourself?
Who have you made promises to that you have not kept?	
What promises have you broken to yourself?	

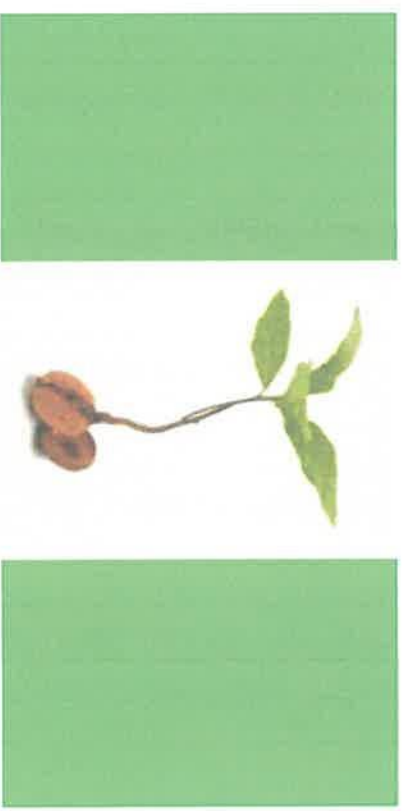
Not doing something and saying that you did is meant to be dishonest.

Preferring to look like you accomplished something over actually doing it is dishonest.

Do you want the consequences of being dishonest? Why not just tell the truth?

Right action to Reconnect Your Heart with those you love.

- Have conversations you have avoided with those close to you. Now is a good time for repair.
- Remember a time that you blamed another for your own results.
- Find that person and discuss this with them. Let them know that you are aware of what you did.
- Look at an incident or a relationship you have not wanted to resolve or complete. Take an action in this situation. Vulnerability is pure strength.
- Since we only experience feeling lost when we have disconnected, offer your hand to create connection with someone in need, someone who might feel lost as you have.
- Accept support from another when you feel lost or need help.



Out beyond ideas of wrongdoing
and right doing, there is a field.
I'll meet you there.

When the soul lies down in that grass,
the world is too full to talk about.
Ideas, language, even the phrase each
other doesn't make any sense.

From Essential Rumi
by Coleman Barks



Keys to radical listening in relationship

- Receive what is being communicated exactly as it is, like a clear mirror
- Listen with open-hearted body-mind without personal thought or feeling.
- Receive a total transmission of all there is at that moment.
- Experience the other as ourselves. In that moment, there is no other.
- Respond to that aspect of their sharing that supports both of us and is for the benefit of all.

*This is the union of love and wisdom.
We express love in the form of presence and
connection, while also transmitting
the wisdom that
everything is complete as it is. We know that
the pain that the other person
is experiencing from
conditioned awareness isn't actually what it
seems to be.*

— Adapted from a teaching by Peter Fenner

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My Goals for this Program are:

The aspects of my past that stand in my way are:

To achieve my goals I will have to feel:

The behaviors essential to achieve my goals are:

What % committed am I at this very moment?

Interim Assignment:

Review journal entries on DeepSee app six days on the second Principle- Personal Responsibility to share with each other.

As your partner speaks, share your experience of them.

You will each find out about yourself by watching all the arguments, stories, and explanations that come up in your mind and just taking in what your partner's experience of you is.

As others speak to you this week, radically listen to and receive what they are offering.



Week 5 - Authenticity



There is a clear distinction between authentic sharing and reactive sharing. We all know when someone is pretending, although we might not know how to deal with it. It's hard-wired into our brains as a survival mechanism. Just notice how children respond to you. Although most of our families did not actively teach us this, we learned how to be by how they responded to us. We knew how to take care of their feelings. Some of us learned how not to make waves, some of us became adroit at manipulation, others blew up. We learned different ways of being, none of them right or wrong. Lots of our adaptive behaviors are a result of our unexperienced anxiety. When authentic sharing occurs, we are given nothing to think about. Why is that?

Who do we think we are?

Do we think we can be fake and people won't know?

Reactive Sharing	Authentic Sharing
<i>I don't care what you think</i>	I'm afraid to hear what you think
<i>I'm not ready to do that</i>	I don't want to do that
<i>I'm fine, you go out without me</i>	I want you to stay with me
<i>I don't understand</i>	I don't like hearing that

The Rose

by Bette Midler

Some say love, it is a river, that drowns the tender reeds

Some say love, it is a razor that leads the heart to bleed

Some say love, it is a hunger, an endless aching need

Some say love, it is a flower and you it's only seed

It's the heart, afraid of breaking that never learns to dance

It's the dream, afraid of waking that never takes the chance

It's the one who won't be taken, who cannot seem to give

And a soul, afraid of dying that never learns to live

When the night has been too lonely and the road becomes too long

And you think that love is only for the lucky and the strong

Just remember in the winter, far beneath the bitter snow lies

The seed that with the sun's love in the spring becomes the rose



Role Play Exercise- Jumping Paradigms:

1. Choose a partner
2. One person will play a homeless vet (see role card) and the other will be person walking along a bike path in Boulder.
3. The walker stops to talk to a person they meet living under a bridge by South Boulder Creek. The person living under the bridge reminds them of someone they have lost.
4. The homeless vet only shares his/her story if the walker is authentic.
5. Have a 5 minute conversation. Then switch roles.
6. One person will play a woman who has lost her children (see role card) and the other will be person walking along a bike path in Boulder.
7. The walker stops to talk to a person they meet sitting on a bench by South Boulder Creek. The sitting on the bench reminds them of someone they have lost.
8. The Woman who has lost her children only shares her story if the walker is authentic.
9. Have a 5 minute conversation.

Then share with group in debrief how the homeless vet knew if the walker was authentic, and what the experience was like for both.

Right Action for Authenticity

When you feel fear in any form, such as anger, resentment or worry, remember, your actions are always a choice. Put yourself in that gap between thought and action. Choose an action that benefits both you and others.



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Interim Assignment:

1. Use the DeepSee app. Do six days on the third Principle - Authenticity, and share your journey each day with your partner.

As your partner speaks, share your experience of them.

You will each find out about yourself by watching all the arguments, stories, and explanations that come up in your mind and just taking in what your partner's experience of you is.

2. Call a family member and infinitely listen to whatever they want to say and be authentic in your responses.



your homecoming will become my homecoming

—

*my selves go with you, only i remain;
a shadow phantom effigy or seeming*

(an almost someone always who's noone)

*a noone who, till their and your returning,
spends the forever of his loneliness
dreaming their eyes have opened to your
morning*

*feeling their stars have risen through your
skies...*

- e.e. cummings

Week 7

Lack of Integrity - Lying

It's difficult to give up believing that when you feel good, things are okay. Things are okay when you are doing what you said you'd do; when you are chaotic and still doing the behavior you chose. When there is no pretense. Sometimes it will feel good.

If you are a liar, you are a morsel for shame.

You can be knocked over by a truth teller.

It's like being blind in a world of light.

The denseness takes you over.

Lying is very addictive. It sets up a pattern that can be very difficult to break. You think that you're fooling people by lying but you're not. You're in illusion if you think people think you're telling the truth when you're lying. In a deep level, the lie comes through very strongly. The listener has to alter his/her relationship with you in some way to keep listening.

"An individual is whole and complete when their word is whole and complete, and their word is whole and complete when they honor their word," says HBS professor Michael C. Jensen. "We can honor our word in one of two ways: by keeping it on time and as promised, or if that becomes impossible, by owning up to the parties counting on us to keep our word in advance and cleaning up the mess our failure to keep our word creates in their lives."

Cleaning Up the Mess

Definition of to “lie” by Merriam Webster: to make an untrue statement with intent to deceive; to create a false or misleading impression.

Do you lie by withholding part of yourself?

Do you lie by pretending to be someone other than you are?

Do you lie by changing your speech “to keep the peace”?

Do you lie by hiding how you feel?

Do you lie to get your way?

What lies are you telling yourself?

What is the effect of a lie?

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